

Lecture 14 (2026-07-19)

Quick Summary

Transitioned from team cohesion and communication dynamics to leadership theories. Analyzed the balance between "Directive" and "Facilitative" leadership styles, emphasizing that the choice is dependent on the organizational context (e.g., creative vs. crisis-driven environments). Introduced the transition into leadership theories including Trait, Behavioral, Contingency, and Contemporary theories. Distinguished between management (formal authority) and leadership (influence and inspiration), noting that non-sanctioned leadership is often as important as formal influence. Added analysis of the Fiedler Contingency Model regarding how performance varies based on task vs. relationship orientation. Introduced Situational Leadership Theory (SLT), which emphasizes follower readiness as the deciding factor for leadership style. Added Path-goal theory, which focuses on leaders "clearing the path" using expectancy theory logic. Introduced Leader-Member Exchange (LMX) and Charismatic Leadership as ways to understand leadership through personal compatibility and visionary influence. **Added analysis of Emotional Intelligence (EI) as a core strategic asset; noted that EI accounts for 58% of job performance and 90% of top performers score high in EI. Highlighted EI's role in fostering psychological safety, conflict resolution, change management, and creating a positive feedback culture. Clarified the scope of the course as internal management (team performance, job satisfaction, and productivity) rather than external service marketing/customer service.**

Key Definitions

Facilitative Leadership: A leadership style focused on pulling ideas from team members, encouraging participation, and involving all employees to increase productivity. **Directive Leadership:** A leadership style where the leader provides clear directions and instructions; most effective in high-pressure, crisis, or urgent situations. **Psychological Safety:** An environment created through communication where team members feel safe to speak up, offer ideas, and take risks without fear of judgment. **Restricting vs. Not Inviting:** A distinction in leadership behavior; "restricting" is an active closing of dialogue, while "not inviting" is a failure to create a space where members feel they **can** contribute. **Manager:** A person who holds a formal designation and uses authority to obtain compliance. **Leader:** Someone who possesses the ability to influence and inspire others toward a goal; leadership is an influence-based characteristic rather than just a title. **Non-sanctioned Leadership:** Influence exerted by individuals without a formal title or appointed position. **Trait Theory:** Initial leadership research focused on personality, social, physical, and willingness, and intellectual attributes (traits) that differentiate leaders from non-leaders. **Big Five Traits (Leadership Context):** * **Extraversion:** The most important trait for leadership; linked to visibility, communication, and confidence. * **Agreeableness & Emotional Stability:** Linked to "charisma" and the ability to bring people together. * **Conscientiousness:** Linked to being disciplined and meeting commitments. * **Openness to Experience:** Linked to creativity and flexibility. **Emotional Intelligence (EI):** The ability to be sensitive to self and others; a core component of EI is empathy. **Defined as a leader's ability to recognize, understand, manage, and influence emotions—both their own and those of others. It consists of five core components:** * **Self-awareness:** Understanding your own emotions, triggers, and strengths. * **Self-regulation:** Managing impulses, staying calm under pressure, and adapting to change. * **Motivation:** Maintaining drive and resilience, even in adversity. * **Empathy:** Sensing others' emotions and perspectives, fostering inclusivity. * **Social skills:** Communicating effectively, resolving conflict, and building relationships. **LPC (Least Preferred Co-worker):** A questionnaire used to determine if a leader is task-oriented or relationship-oriented. **Fiedler Contingency Model:** A theory stating that effective group performance depends on the match between the leader's style and the degree to which the situation gives control to the leader. **Contingency Dimensions:** The three factors used to define the situation in contingency models: 1.

Leader-member relations 2. Task structure 3. Position power **Situational Leadership Theory (SLT):** A contingency theory that focuses on the followers; successful leadership is achieved by selecting the right leadership style, which is contingent on the level of the followers' readiness (e.g., age, experience, and receptivity). **Path-goal theory:** A contingency model of leadership that extracts key elements from the Ohio State leadership research (initiating structure and consideration) and the expectancy theory of motivation. It is based on the belief that effective leaders clarify the path to help followers achieve work goals. **Leader-Participation Model:** A model that relates leadership behavior and participation in decision making. The leader's behavior must adjust to reflect the task structure of the work being assigned. **Leader-Member Exchange (LMX):** A theory regarding the personal compatibility (competency or extroverted personality) between a leader and a specific subordinate. **In-group vs. Out-group:** * **In-group:** Members the leader has high trust in; they are considered "favorites," have higher interaction, and are more helpful. * **Out-group:** Members who have more formal, task-based relationships with the leader; they are not part of the inner circle of high interaction. **Charismatic Leadership:** A style where leaders have a vision (an "idealized goal") and high aspirations. They are often perceived as having an "aura" and are willing to take personal risks and self-sacrifice for the well-being of the group. While some traits may be "born," charismatic behaviors can be "made" through training. **Crisis Leadership:** The ability of a leader to maintain composure and communicate with clarity and empathy during uncertain or high-pressure situations. **Cultural Intelligence:** The use of EI to enhance cross-cultural sensitivity, vital for leading diverse teams and ensuring inclusivity.

[shot_00-14-23.png] TITLE: Learning Objectives for Leadership Theories The slide lists the following learning requirements for a module on leadership: * Summarize the conclusions of trait theories of leadership. * Identify the central tenets and main limitations of behavioral theories.

[shot_00-19-10.png] TITLE: Leadership Concept Definition The slide defines leadership as "the ability to influence a group toward the achievement of a vision or set of goals." It highlights two key distinctions: - Not just all leaders are managers, nor are all managers leaders. - Nonsanctioned leadership is often as important or more important than formal influence.

[shot_00-20-46.png] TITLE: Trait Theories of Leadership The slide defines trait theories of leadership as focusing on personal qualities and characteristics. It notes that the search for personality, social, physical, or intellectual attributes that differentiate leaders from non-leaders dates back to the earliest stages of leadership research.

[shot_00-23-45.png] TITLE: Traits of Good Leaders The slide lists four key characteristics of good leaders, correlating them with personality traits: - Like being around people. - Are able to assert themselves (extraverted). - Are disciplined and able to keep commitments they make (conscientious). - Are creative and flexible (open).

[shot_00-25-51.png] TITLE: Leadership and Emotional Intelligence The slide is titled "Contd.." and discusses the role of emotional intelligence in leadership. The main points are: * Another trait that may indicate effective leadership is **emotional intelligence**. * A core component of EI is empathy. * The link between EI and leadership effectiveness may be worth investigating in greater detail.

[shot_00-29-58.png] TITLE: Emotional Intelligence and Leadership The slide continues a discussion on leadership traits, stating: - Another trait that may indicate effective leadership is **emotional intelligence**. - A core component of EI is empathy. - The link between EI and leadership effectiveness may be worth investigating in greater detail.

[shot_00-34-18.png] TITLE: Leadership Traits Conclusion The slide presents two main conclusions regarding the relationship between personality traits and leadership: - Traits can predict leadership. - Traits do a better job predicting the emergence of leaders and the appearance of leadership than actually distinguishing between effective and ineffective leaders.

[shot_00-35-32.png] TITLE: GLOBE Study Cultural Leadership Example Contd.. • The GLOBE study suggests there are international differences in preference for initiating structure and consideration. - Based on the values of Brazilian employees, a U.S. manager leading a team in Brazil would need to be

team-oriented, participative, and humane. Leaders high in consideration would succeed best in this culture.

[shot_00-36-28.png] TITLE: Summary of Trait and Behavioral Theories The slide summarizes the key takeaways from Trait and Behavioral Theories of leadership: - Leaders who have certain traits and who display culturally appropriate consideration and structuring behaviors do appear to be more effective. - Traits and

[shot_00-37-19.png] TITLE: Fiedler Contingency Model The slide is titled "Contrast Contingency Theories of Leadership." It defines the Fiedler contingency model as follows: "effective group performance depends upon the proper match between the leader's style and the degree to which the situation gives control to the leader." Below this, it introduces the "least preferred coworker (LPC) questionnaire" and lists two bullet points: - Task- or relationship-oriented. - Assumes leadership style is fixed. (A red arrow points to this second bullet point).

[shot_00-38-43.png] TITLE: Contingency Theories of Leadership The slide is titled "Contrast Contingency Theories of Leadership" and focuses on "Defining the Situation." It lists three "Contingency dimensions": * Leader-member relations * Task structure * Position power

[shot_00-39-53.png] (No content provided in transcript segment for this shot)

[shot_00-45-58.png] TITLE: Situational Leadership Theory (SLT) The slide contains the following text: "Contd.. Situational leadership theory (SLT) is a contingency theory that focuses on the followers. * Successful leadership is achieved by selecting the right leadership style, which is contingent on the level of the followers' readiness."

[shot_01-15-09.png] TITLE: Path-goal theory slide The slide is titled "Contd.." and focuses on the "Path-goal theory:". It contains two bullet points: - Contingency model of leadership that extracts key elements from the Ohio State leadership research on initiating structure and consideration and the expectancy theory of motivation. - Derived from belief that effective leaders clarify the path to help followers achieve work goals. The slide also includes the

[shot_01-15-54.png] TITLE: Path-goal theory definition The slide defines "Path-goal theory" as a contingency model of leadership. It notes that the theory extracts key elements from the Ohio State leadership research (specifically "initiating structure" and "consideration") and incorporates the expectancy theory of motivation. The slide concludes by stating that the theory is derived from the belief that effective leaders clarify the path to help followers achieve work goals.

[shot_01-17-24.png] TITLE: Leader-Participation Model The slide presents the following text: - The leader-participation model relates leadership behavior and participation in decision making. - Leader behavior must adjust to reflect the task structure.

[shot_01-22-11.png] TITLE: Key Characteristics of a Charismatic Leader The slide, titled "Contemporary Theories of

[shot_01-24-19.png] TITLE: Charismatic Leadership Theory The slide addresses the question, "Are Charismatic Leaders Born or Made?" It states that while some individuals are born with charismatic traits, others are trained to exhibit charismatic behaviors. It highlights three methods for developing these traits: - Develop the aura of charisma. - Create a bond that inspires others to follow. - Bring out the potential in followers by tapping into their emotions.

[shot_01-48-09.png] TITLE: Why EI Matters for Leaders The slide outlines five key reasons why Emotional Intelligence (EI) is critical for leadership: - Performance Predictor: Studies indicate that emotional intelligence accounts for [58% of job performance, with 90% of top performers scoring high]. - Team Engagement: EI-driven leaders foster psychological safety, which boosts collaboration and innovation. - Conflict Resolution: Leaders with high EI can de-escalate tensions and mediate disputes constructively. - Change Management: In hybrid and fast-evolving environments, emotionally intelligent

leaders help teams adapt and stay resilient. - Feedback Culture: EI enables leaders to deliver feedback that's honest yet supportive, promoting growth without defensiveness.

[shot_01-53-22.png] TITLE: How to Develop EI as a Leader The slide lists four key strategies for developing EI: - Reflective Practice: Using journaling, mindfulness, and feedback loops to build self-awareness. - Active Listening: Prioritizing understanding over responding. - Empathy Exercises: Role-playing and perspective-taking to deepen emotional insight. - Training Programs: Leadership development initiatives that integrate EI assessments and coaching.

[shot_01-57-48.png] TITLE: Strategic Applications of Emotional Intelligence (EI) The slide outlines three key applications of Emotional Intelligence (EI) in leadership: * **Coaching and Development:** EI helps leaders tailor mentoring approaches to individual needs. * **Crisis Leadership:** During uncertainty, emotionally intelligent leaders maintain composure and communicate with clarity and empathy. * **Cultural Intelligence:** EI enhances cross-cultural sensitivity, vital for global teams and inclusive leadership.

[shot_01-58-40.png] TITLE: What Is Emotional Intelligence in Leadership? The slide defines emotional intelligence as a leader's ability to recognize, understand, manage, and influence emotions—both their own and those of others. It outlines five key components: * **Self-awareness:** Understanding your own emotions, triggers, and strengths. * **Self-regulation:** Managing impulses, staying calm under pressure, and adapting to change. * **Motivation:** Maintaining drive and resilience, even in adversity. * **Empathy:** Sensing others' emotions and perspectives, fostering inclusivity. * **Social skills:** Communicating effectively, resolving conflict, and building relationships.

Worked Examples

Case Study: The Silent Meeting (Riya) Scenario: Riya, a new project manager, presents a detailed agenda with confidence, but the team remains silent and does not offer suggestions. A colleague notes that while Riya is "clear and decisive," there is "no space" for others to contribute.

Question 1: What could Riya have done differently to encourage participation? * **Build Rapport & Ice-break:** Since it was her first meeting, she should have started with introductions and interactions to make the team comfortable. * **Explicitly Invite Input:** She could have directly asked for specific inputs rather than just presenting information. * **Create an Informal Environment:** Reduce the "guard" of the team members to foster a safer communication environment. * **Use Open-Ended Questions:** Instead of binary questions, use questions that allow participants to share their perspectives/interests. * **Acknowledge Diversity:** Recognize different personality types and diversity within the team to tailor her approach. * **Strategy for Variety:** Use different grouping methods (e.g., small sub-groups) to give individuals more courage to speak.

Question 2: Is it better for a leader to be highly directive or more facilitative—and why? * **Analysis of "Best":** It is not a single-dimension choice; the "best" depends on the **context**. * **Facilitative Context:** Best for creative roles, brainstorming, and building team cohesion/productivity. * **Directive Context:** Best for "times of crisis," "emergencies," "specific contingencies," or in highly restricted environments (e.g., defense/military roles).

Theory Application: Cultural Leadership (GLOBE Study) Scenario: A U.S. manager is leading a team of Brazilian employees. * **Application:** The manager must shift toward being team-oriented, participative, and humane. * **Reasoning:** Leadership effectiveness is tied to "consideration" and "structure." Because the Brazilian culture values "consideration," the leader must match their behavior to the cultural expectation of the team to be effective.

Fiedler Model: Performance outcomes based on Situation Scenario: Analyzing the match between leadership style (Task vs. Relationship) and environment. * **Favorable Situations:** * **Task-oriented:** Leads to Good performance. * **Relationship-oriented:** Leads to Poor performance (reasoning: leader "leaves people at their own"). * **Moderate Situations:** * **Task-oriented:** Leads to declining performance

(reasoning: too demanding, lacks room for creativity). * **Relationship-oriented:** Leads to better performance (reasoning: provides balance where some flexibility is needed but deadlines are still noted). * **Unfavorable Situations:** * **Relationship-oriented:** Leads to higher performance (reasoning: high level of trust/consideration is required).

Case Study: The "Over-Accessible" Manager (Jayesh's Dilemma) Scenario: A manager is very approachable and "good" with his team, leading to a situation where new hires bypass the immediate mid-level supervisors to ask the senior manager for help with small issues. * **The Problem:** While the manager is "nice," he is creating **dependencies**. He is not letting the intermediate team members do their jobs of mentoring. * **The Consequence:** A "domino effect" occurs. It wastes the senior manager's time and leaves the mid-level managers feeling cut off and not empowered to lead their teams. * **Resolution:** The leader must "break the barrier." They must ensure the middle management layer is capable and empowered to resolve issues, forcing the new hires to build rapport with their direct supervisors.

Case Study: The "Good Human" vs. the Formal Role (Riyan's Dilemma) Scenario: A leader is exceptionally helpful and approachable. While this is a "good" trait as a human being, it can lead to **Role Ambiguity** or **Role Clash** when it causes team members to bypass the standard organizational structure or when it distracts from the leader's primary duties. * **The Analysis:** This isn't necessarily a fault of the individual's character, but a failure of **Organization Culture/Governance**. * **Reasoning:** If there isn't a clear, reliable channel for issues (like HR or a PSH committee), people will naturally "climb" the ladder to find someone who will listen. If a leader is "too nice," they become the safety net, and the formal management layer (the "filter") is bypassed. * **Resolution:** The organization must provide clear, reliable "routes" so that "good" leaders don't have to sacrifice their primary roles to solve structural problems.

Case Study: The "Empathetic" High-Pressure Leadership (Apple Example) Scenario: During the launch of the iPhone, the leadership (CEO/CTO) appeared demanding and less friendly to the teams (hardware, software, graphics) due to intense timeline pressures. * **Analysis:** While the leadership appeared less empathetic in the moment of the crisis/pressure, the team later realized that the leader's goal was to provide them with the opportunity to build something extraordinary. * **Reasoning:** This highlights the difference between **perceived** empathy (how others see you during a crunch) and **actual** empathetic leadership (providing a valuable opportunity and growth despite the pressure).

Formulas & Rules

The Rule of Context (Leadership): Determining the appropriate leadership style (Directive vs. Facilitative) is not a fixed choice. It must be judged based on: 1. **Type of Work:** Creative/collaborative roles $\rightarrow$ Facilitative. 2. **Urgency/Safety:** Crisis/emergency/restricted environments $\rightarrow$ Directive. 3. **Specific Industry Rules:** * **Banking/Public Dealing/Manufacturing:** Require Task-oriented approach due to strict deadlines and need for precision. * **Creative Fields (Ad Agencies, Music):** Require Relationship-oriented approach to allow for imagination/creativity.

Fiedler Contingency Match Rule: Effective group performance is determined by the match between: 1. **Leader Style:** (Task-oriented vs. Relationship-oriented, determined by LPC). 2. **Situational Context:** * **Favorable:** Task-oriented matches best. * **Moderate:** Relationship-oriented is more effective for balancing creativity and deadlines. * **Unfavorable:** Relationship-oriented is necessary when trust is low and situations are complex.

Theory Progression Rule: 1. **Trait Theory:** Predicts the **emergence** of leaders (who will become a leader based on personality). 2. **Behavioral Theory:** Focuses on people management (how they act). 3. **Contingency Theory:** Focuses on the **fit** between leadership behavior and the situational context. 4. **Situational Leadership Theory (SLT):** Focuses on **follower readiness** (skills/willingness) as the primary driver for selecting a style.

Path-Goal Rule: A leader's effectiveness is determined by their ability to "clear the path." They must take the heavy lifting of providing structure and consideration so that followers can focus on their specific

work goals.

Leader-Participation Rule: Leader behavior (how much a leader is involved in decision-making) should be adjusted specifically to the **task structure** of the work.

Internal vs. External Context Rule: In the context of this course (Managing People and Organization), **Emotional Intelligence** and **Empathy** are primarily applied to **internal** factors: * **Internal focus:** Team member performance, job satisfaction, and internal collaboration. * **External focus:** Customer service and marketing (while these require empathy to understand customer pain points, they are outside the primary scope of this specific leadership module).

Tricky Logic & Traps

Restricting vs. Not Inviting: Students may treat "not encouraging participation" as a single issue. The instructor distinguishes between a leader who is **restricting** (actively shutting down) and one who is **not inviting** (passive failure to create space). The solution depends on which one is occurring. **The "Superior Style" Trap:** When asked which leadership style is "better," the answer is not "Facilitative" or "Directive." The trick is recognizing that it is not a single dimension; the "correct" answer must include the **context** of the organization (e.g., a defense role requires directive leadership in a crisis, while a creative team requires facilitative leadership). **The "Announcement" Distinction:** If a meeting's purpose is a pure announcement (logistics, deadlines), there is less scope for discussion. The failure to encourage participation is only a leadership "failure" if the meeting's goal was to seek input or build cohesion. **The "Prediction" Trap (Trait Theory):** A common misconception is that traits distinguish between **effective and ineffective** leaders. The actual distinction is that traits are better at predicting the **emergence** of leaders (who will become a leader) than their related effectiveness. **The "Fixed Style" Trap (Fiedler):** While many leadership models suggest leaders can adapt their style to the situation, the Fiedler Contingency Model assumes that **leadership style is fixed**. The "match" is between a fixed style and a changing situation. **The "Preheating" Logic:** Introduction and rapport-building are not just "social" extras. They are "preheating" or "warming up"—essential steps to build trust and break down guards so that team members feel comfortable providing commitment and input. **Management vs. Leadership:** Do not treat these as synonymous. Management is based on **authority/title**; leadership is based on **influence/inspiration**. **The "Dependency" Trap (Over-Accessibility):** A leader being "too nice" or too accessible can lead to **dependency**. If a leader is so approachable that subordinates bypass the immediate reporting manager (middle management), it creates a "domino effect" of wasted time and undermines the development of the middle manager. **Role Ambiguity/Clash:** A leader may be "too good" at the "human" side of leadership, which leads to **Role Ambiguity**. If they are so helpful that it becomes the "default" for employees to bypass the chain of command, it indicates a failure in **Organization Culture** (lack of reliable, standard channels) rather than a failure of the leader's personality. **Follower Readiness (SLT):** Don't mistake "Situation" (Fiedler) for "Follower Readiness" (SLT). While both are contingency models, SLT specifically hinges on the attributes of the followers (e.g., their age, experience, and willingness). **In-Group vs. Out-Group Reality:** "In-group" isn't just a feeling; it is based on **personal compatibility** (common background, language, or similar styles). Out-groups are defined by their **formal/task-only** relationship. **Charismatic "Born vs. Made":** Don't assume charismatic leaders are only born with an "aura." While some are born with these traits, the behavior (sincerity, vision, and risk-taking) can be taught and developed. **The "Empathetic Perspective" Trap:** A leader may appear to lack empathy in high-pressure situations (e.g., the Apple case). The trick is to distinguish between **outward behavior during a crisis** and the **underlying intent/opportunity** provided to the team.

Exam Pointers

- **Preparation vs. Execution:** Even if a leader is well-prepared, they must proactively build rapport if it is the first meeting.

- **Communication Style:** Use open-ended questions to gauge what team members are "best into" or what they enjoy to foster positivity.
- **Team Composition:** When selecting leaders or methods, consider the impact of personality diversity on team effectiveness.
- **Cultural Sensitivity:** Leadership must be tailored to the cultural expectations of the team (e.g., the GLOBE study's findings on Brazilian teams).
- **Adaptability:** In modern contexts (post-COVID, AI-driven), leaders must be "creative and flexible" to handle high uncertainty and complex, shifting requirements.
- **Contextual Selection:** When evaluating a scenario, ask: "What is the specific job role?" (e.g., a bank clerk vs. an ad executive) to determine if the role permits a relationship-oriented approach or requires a task-oriented one.
- **Hierarchy Awareness:** Be wary of "skipping levels." A leader's role includes ensuring the intermediate management layers are empowered and that the "filter" of the organization is maintained.
- **Identify the Root Cause:** If a "good" person is being bypassed as a manager, look for a lack of **Organization Culture/Governance** (lack of clear, reliable channels) as the underlying "why" rather than just a personality flaw.
- **Internal Focus Logic:** When asked about "Empathy" or "Emotional Intelligence," prioritize the context of **team performance** and **internal safety** over external customer-facing tactics unless specifically asked about marketing.

Sources

MBA ZG511 Lecture 7.pptx MBA ZG511 Lecture 10.pptx MPO Session 9-13 2026.pdf MBA ZG511 Lecture 11.pptx MBA ZG511 Harvard Case study.pptx